Desire Abdoul Kader BONZI

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Languages: French (Native) | English (Professional) | Japanese (Basic)

Cybersecurity Researcher | Network Security | Anomaly Detection

PROFILE

Cybersecurity researcher with hands-on experience in threat detection, authentication telemetry analysis, and open-source intelligence (OSINT) processing. Currently completing a Master's degree at Ritsumeikan University, with active research on graph-based detection of credential-based lateral movement directly applicable to cyber threat intelligence (CTI) workflows. Combines machine learning knowledge, network security engineering, and system design to build explainable, resource-efficient detection mechanisms. Proven ability to collect, analyze, and correlate multi-source security data at scale.

RESEARCH INTEREST

Cyber Threat Intelligence | Graph-based Security Analytics | SIEM and Security Monitoring | Authentication and Identity Security | Detection of Lateral Movement | AI for Cybersecurity | Network Security Monitoring

EDUCATION

- **Ritsumeikan University, Japan**

  Master of Computer Science (Cybersecurity) | *Sept 2024 – Sept 2026 (Expected)*

  Thesis: *Enhancing SME Security Posture Through an Open-Source SOC Architecture and Authentication-Time Detection*

  Research contributions include:

  - Design of an open-source SOC architecture for SMEs
  - Development of authentication-time detection for credential-based lateral movement
  - Graph-based modeling of identity-host relationships
  - Implementation using Security Onion, Elasticsearch, Neo4j, and Python

Research Publications & Work in Progress

Graph-Based Early Detection of Credential-Based Lateral Movement

Proposes a deterministic detection approach based on identity-host authentication graph expansion.

Key contributions:

- Formal definition of First Authenticated Pivot
- Detection at authentication time instead of post-execution artifacts
- Implementation using Security Onion telemetry and graph analytics

Research Projects

Authentication Graph Detection System (PIVOT-Graph)

Developed a security monitoring system capable of detecting credential abuse at the moment an identity expands access across hosts.

Key capabilities:

- Graph-based modeling of authentication relationships
- Early detection of lateral movement
- Deterministic pivot detection
- Integration with SOC monitoring pipelines

Open-Source SOC Architecture for SMEs

Designing a lightweight SOC framework enabling SMEs to perform effective security monitoring without enterprise-level resources.

Features:

- Log ingestion using Elastic stack
- Authentication telemetry analysis
- Graph-based correlation
- Explainable alert generation

Professional Experience

IT Officer, Tsebo Solutions Group (2019 - 2024)

Responsibilities included:

- Administered enterprise network infrastructure across industrial sites
- Supported secure network segmentation and access control enforcement across multi-site
- Managed incident response workflows, coordinating between IT and operational teams

CERTIFICATIONS

- NVIDIA Fundamentals of Deep Learning
- Cisco Introduction to Cybersecurity | Cisco ENCOR 350-401 (CCNP)
- CompTIA Network+ | CompTIA Linux+ | CompTIA Security+